Power BI-to-Excel Coverage

How every Power BI visual comes out in the Excel export, in both modes (visuals as data tables, and as Excel charts), how faithful the result is, and how the export recognises the visual. Every type has an explicit strategy; none fails.

48
built-in visual types, each with a strategy

23
AppSource visuals with their own rules, plus a rule for any other

86 · 0 failed
visuals on the ExportTest report (20 pages)

0
Excel repair prompts, both modes

Built-in visual types by strategy

48 types



ExportTest report visuals by strategy

86 visuals



NATIVE
types 16 tested 31
A real Excel equivalent: an Excel chart, or an Excel Table with the report's formatting.

CONSTRUCTED
types 8 tested 23
Built from Excel parts that keep the meaning: tiles, sparklines, outlines, live formulas.

APPROXIMATE
types 1 tested 1
The closest Excel chart keeps the numbers; the visible difference is named here.

TABLE
types 6 tested 17
No Excel chart reads correctly (maps, trees): a formatted table in the visual's colours.

FILTER CHIP
types 4 tested 8
Slicers become the sheet's filter bar: field and selection, "All" when none.

NO DATA
types 8 tested 5
Text boxes, shapes, buttons and the like hold no data: left out quietly.

NOT EXPORTABLE
types 5 tested 1
Power BI refuses to export the data: the sheet's notes name the visual.

Strongest first. A correct table beats a chart that only looks similar: a visual becomes an Excel chart only when the chart keeps its meaning.

Fidelity. High: reads the same as in Power BI. Medium: the same data and colours, drawn differently. A dash: nothing to export.

Two modes. Data tables mode writes every data visual as an Excel Table; Charts mode turns the native chart types into Excel charts, with their data on a hidden sheet.

Known limits

- Totals are filled only where adding the rows gives Power BI's total (sums, counts, min / max); ratios, averages and distinct counts stay blank.
- New-card reference labels appear when Power BI includes them in the export.
- Table sparklines need permission to query the semantic model (Build); without it a note names them.
- Not yet confirmed on the live Power BI service: the sparkline queries and reference labels.

Coverage matrix · charts

Each chart type in both export modes. "Recognised as" is the visual type the export reads from the report. ✓ = on the ExportTest report; part = some of the types in the row.

POWER BI VISUAL	RECOGNISED AS	STRATEGY	DATA TABLES MODE	CHARTS MODE	FIDELITY	TEST
BARS AND COLUMNS						
Stacked bar	`barChart`	NATIVE	Table · legend colours	Stacked bar chart	High	✓
Clustered bar	`clusteredBarChart`	NATIVE	Table · series colours	Clustered bar chart	High	✓
100% stacked bar	`hundredPercentStackedBarChart`	NATIVE	Table · legend colours	100% stacked bar chart	High	✓
Stacked column	`columnChart`	NATIVE	Table · legend colours	Stacked column chart	High	✓
Clustered column	`clusteredColumnChart`	NATIVE	Table · series colours	Clustered column chart; axis titles and hidden axes as in the report	High	✓
100% stacked column	`hundredPercentStackedColumnChart`	NATIVE	Table · legend colours	100% stacked column chart	High	✓
LINES AND AREAS						
Line	`lineChart`	NATIVE	Table · series colours	Line chart; every category label shown, up to 60 points	High	✓
Area · stacked · 100%	`areaChart, stackedAreaChart, hundredPercentStackedAreaChart`	NATIVE	Table · series or legend colours	Area, stacked area and 100% stacked area charts	High	✓
Line and stacked column	`lineStackedColumnComboChart`	NATIVE	Table · legend and line colours	Combo chart: stacked columns, the line on a secondary axis, read once per category	High	✓
Line and clustered column	`lineClusteredColumnComboChart`	NATIVE	Table · series colours	Combo chart: clustered columns, the line on a secondary axis	High	✓
PARTS, FLOWS AND SPREAD						
Pie · Donut	`pieChart, donutChart`	NATIVE	Table · slice colours	Pie or doughnut chart in the slice colours	High	✓
Scatter · bubble	`scatterChart`	NATIVE	Table · series colours	Scatter chart, or a bubble chart when Size is set; a series per legend value, points named	High	✓
Waterfall	`waterfallChart`	CONSTRUCTED	Table · increase / decrease / total colours	Stacked columns on a hidden running base; labels like 2.47M	High	✓
Funnel	`funnel`	CONSTRUCTED	Table · series colour	Centred bars on a hidden offset, largest stage on top, values inside	High	✓
Ribbon	`ribbonChart`	APPROXIMATE	Table · legend colours	Stacked column chart: the same values and colours; the ribbons between columns aren't drawn	Medium	✓

Coverage matrix · tables, cards, maps and slicers

POWER BI VISUAL	RECOGNISED AS	STRATEGY	EXCEL OUTPUT, BOTH MODES	FIDELITY	TEST
TABLES AND MATRICES					
Table	`tableEx`	NATIVE	Excel Table with the report's colour scales, rules, data bars and icons; a live SUBTOTAL totals row; sparklines that stay right after sorting	High	✓
Matrix	`pivotTable`	CONSTRUCTED	Column fields pivoted, with live Total columns; row hierarchies stepped as in Power BI, with group totals and Excel outline buttons	High	✓
CARDS AND KPIS					
Card	`card`	CONSTRUCTED	KPI tile: label and large value, in the report's value colour and accent	High	✓
New card	`cardVisual`	CONSTRUCTED	One tile per measure, side by side, each with its reference labels beneath	High	✓
Multi-row card	`multiRowCard`	CONSTRUCTED	Tile with the first field large and the others as sub-rows	High	✓
KPI	`kpi`	CONSTRUCTED	Trend card: value in the status colour, "Goal: x (±y%)", an Excel sparkline, "Target met / not met"	High	✓
Gauge	`gauge`	CONSTRUCTED	Tile led by the gauge's value; target, minimum and maximum beneath	High	✓
HIERARCHIES AND MAPS					
Treemap	`treemap`	TABLE	Table with each group's cells in its tile colour	Medium	✓
Map · Filled · Azure · Shape map	`map, filledMap, azureMap, shapeMap`	TABLE	Locations and values as a table, bubble and fill colours kept	Medium	✓
Decomposition tree	`decompositionTreeVisual`	TABLE	The analysed value by its explain-by fields	Medium	✓
SLICERS, AND VISUALS WITHOUT DATA					
Slicer · button · list · text	`slicer, advancedSlicerVisual, listSlicer, textSlicer`	FILTER CHIP	"Field: selection" chips in the filter bar; hidden slicers count too	High	part
Text box · image · shape · buttons · navigators · smart narrative · Q&A	`textbox, image, basicShape, actionButton, page- / bookmarkNavigator, aiNarratives, qnaVisual`	NO DATA	Left out quietly: they hold nothing to export	–	part
Key influencers · R · Python · paginated report · Power Apps	`keyDriversVisual, scriptVisual, pythonVisual, rdlVisual, powerApps`	NOT EXPORTABLE	Power BI doesn't export their data; the sheet's notes name each one	–	part

AppSource visuals

Recognised by type name and rebuilt the way each visual's own code draws it.

VISUAL	STRATEGY	EXCEL OUTPUT
Double Donut	CONSTRUCTED	Inner ring colours on the category, outer ring shades on the subcategory
Nested Bars	CONSTRUCTED	A row per category: total and chosen subset, in the bar colours
Comparison Table	CONSTRUCTED	The visual's grid, its bars as Excel data bars
Progress Icon	CONSTRUCTED	KPI tile led by its value, icon colour as the accent
Dual KPI	CONSTRUCTED	Two trend cards with sparklines, "Last N days"
Histogram	CONSTRUCTED	The visual's own bins with their frequency
Date Range Picker · Timeline · Chiclet · Text filter · Attribute slicer	FILTER CHIP	Chips in the filter bar
Deneb · Bullet · Gantt · Mekko · Stream · Radar · Tornado · Sankey · Word cloud · Sunburst · Aster	TABLE	Tables in each visual's own colours (Deneb: from its colour field)
Power Automate button	NO DATA	Left out quietly
Any other AppSource visual	TABLE	Table in theme colours per value, with a note

Verification

Run on the ExportTest report (20 pages, 86 visuals), in both modes.

105/105 automated checks

31 native Excel charts

142 live formulas

13 pages compared with Power BI

- Every page replayed through the export with the rows Power BI sends; structural checks clean (headers, merges, hidden rows).
- Both workbooks opened in desktop Excel with no repair prompt: charts, sparklines, data bars, tables and formulas all load.
- Sorting a table with sparklines keeps every sparkline on its own row.

Screenshots of each page in Power BI Desktop and in Excel, with notes, and the full list of the 86 visuals: **Power BI vs Excel – Side-by-Side Report** (Google Sheet).